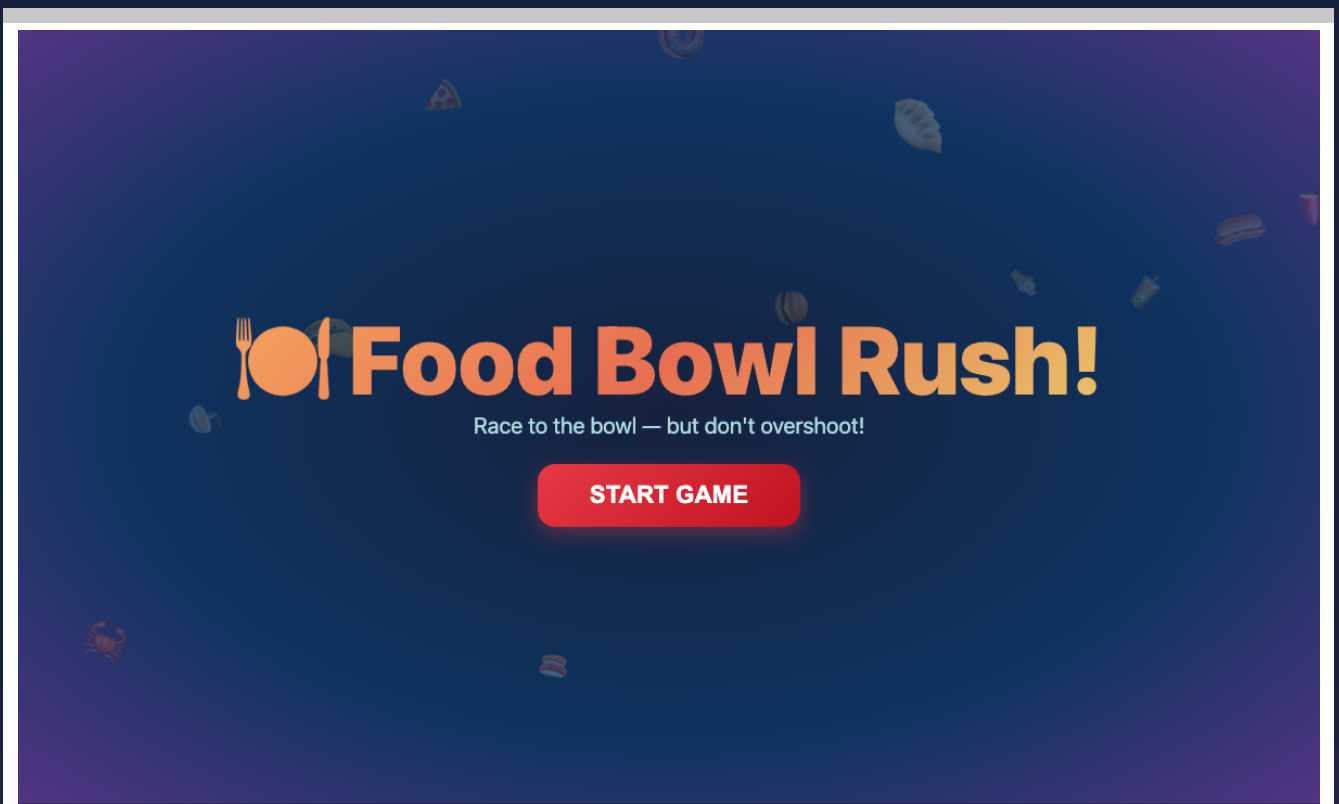


A GAME DEV STORY

How We Built Food Bowl Rush!

A Game Built by Dad & Celine

March 2026



The Food Bowl Rush! title screen

From idea to game in one afternoon!

12 Food Fighters | Special Powers | Web Audio Sounds | Pure HTML+CSS+JS

! Our Game Idea

Where Food Bowl Rush was born!

It all started with a question: "What if food could race?"

We imagined a world where your favourite foods could hop along a track trying to land perfectly in a big bowl at the end. Jump too short and you'll never get there. But jump too far... and you OVERSHOOT!

The Big Idea

THE RACE: Two players each pick a food character. They press their key to make the food jump. First one to land IN the bowl zone wins - but not too far!

THE BOWL ZONE: There is a golden zone near the end of the track. Land inside it and you win! But go even one pixel further and your food flies off into space. Poof!

SPECIAL POWERS: Each food has its own personality. The Crab sometimes shuffles backwards! Sushi gets faster every jump. Donut saves up for a massive 3rd jump. Every food is different!

What Makes It Fun?

- Randomness - you never quite know how far you will jump!
- Personality - each food fighter has a unique trick
- Tension - when you are close to the bowl, every press matters
- Laughter - watching the Crab shuffle backwards is hilarious

Player 1, pick your food!

Click any food to choose your fighter



 Crab ✦ CRABWALK Sometimes shuffles BACKWARDS!	 Ramen ✦ SLURP BOOST Random giant speed surges!	 Sweet Potato ✦ CRISPY HOP Steady & predictable jumps	 Taco ✦ SHELL SPIN Wildly unpredictable distance!
 Pizza ✦ CHEESE DRAG Sometimes gets totally stuck!	 Sushi ✦ ROLLING RUSH Gets FASTER every jump!	 Donut ✦ SUGAR RUSH Every 3rd jump is MASSIVE!	 Burger ✦ BEEF BOUNCE Big powerful jumps!
 Corn Dog ✦ STICK LAUNCH Rare MEGA jumps from nowhere!	 Dumpling ✦ STEAM POP Occasionally double-jumps!	 Ice Cream ✦ BRAIN FREEZE Sometimes freezes in place!	 Boba Tea ✦ BUBBLE POP Wildest jumps of all!

The food selection screen - 12 food fighters to choose from!

> Step 1: Planning the Game

Before writing code, we figured out what we were building!

Good games start with good planning. We thought about three big things:



Meet the 12 Food Fighters!

Name	Special Trait	What It Does
Crab	Crabwalk	30% chance of shuffling BACKWARDS!
Ramen	Slurp Boost	Sometimes zooms with a giant speed surge!
Sweet Potato	Crispy Hop	Steady & reliable - always lands 9-15 units
Taco	Shell Spin	Wildly unpredictable - anywhere from 2 to 26!
Pizza	Cheese Drag	Sometimes gets completely stuck - too gooey!
Sushi	Rolling Rush	Gets faster and faster the more it jumps!
Donut	Sugar Rush	Every 3rd jump is MASSIVE (19-24 units!)
Burger	Beef Bounce	Big, powerful jumps every time (12-23)
Corn Dog	Stick Launch	15% chance of a MEGA launch (23-30 units!)
Dumpling	Steam Pop	25% chance of a double jump in a row!
Ice Cream	Brain Freeze	Sometimes freezes solid - cannot move at all!
Boba Tea	Bubble Pop	Wildest jumps of all - 2 to 27, pure chaos!

* Step 2: Building the Screens

Every good game needs multiple screens to guide the player!

Food Bowl Rush has 5 screens that players move through. Each screen is a full-page layer that we show or hide with a JavaScript function called `showScreen()`.

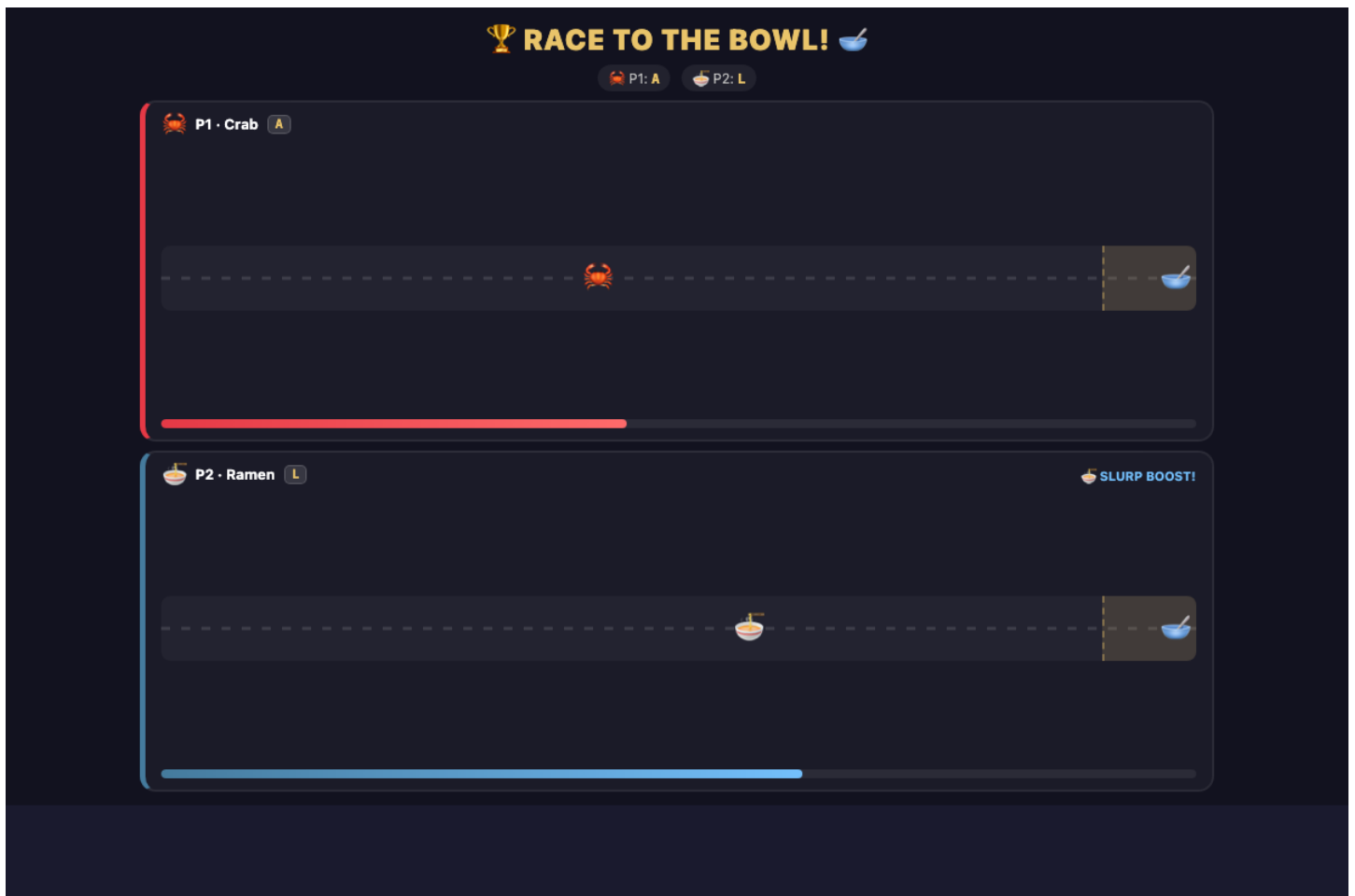


How it works in code: Every screen is a `<div class="screen">` in the HTML. By default they are all hidden (`display: none`). Adding the class "active" to one makes it show up. Super simple!

The Race Screen

The race screen is the most complex. It builds a "lane" for each player with:

- A track with dashed lines and a golden bowl zone on the right
- A food emoji that slides along the track using CSS transitions
- A progress bar at the bottom showing how far you have gone
- A message area that shows your food special power activating!



Crab vs Ramen - mid-race! Ramen just activated Slurp Boost!

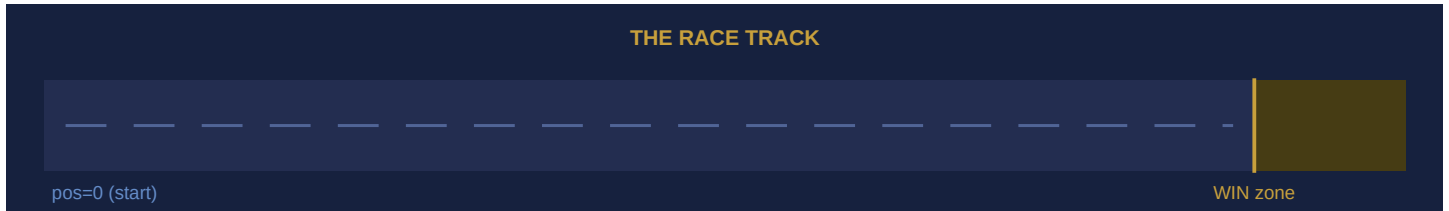
> Step 3: The Jump Mechanic

The heart of the game - how each press moves your food!

Every time you press your key, the game calls `calcJump()` which figures out how far your food will hop. Then `applyJump()` moves it and checks whether you won, overshoot, or just moved forward!

The Track - How Positions Work

The track is a number line from 0 (start) to 100 (end). Your food lives at a position number. When you jump, we add the jump distance to your position.



Three Things That Can Happen

Normal Jump

$\text{pos} + \text{jump} < 92$

Move forward!

Update progress bar!

WIN!

$\text{pos} \geq 92$ to 100

Land in bowl!

Play fanfare!

OVERSHOOT!

$\text{pos} > 100$

Food flies off!

Elimination!

Each Food Jump Style

"Each food has its own special jump style!" We wrote a big switch statement - it's like a set of rules, one for each food. Depending on which food you picked, the jump calculation is completely different. That's what makes the game feel alive!

Step 4: Special Powers in Code

How we turned game ideas into real JavaScript!

Each food special power is just a few lines of code inside the `calcJump()` function. Here is how we turned each idea into reality:

Name	Power	How It Works in Code
Crab	Crabwalk	<code>Math.random() < 0.30</code> - if true, return a NEGATIVE number to go backwards!
Ramen	Slurp Boost	25% chance to multiply the jump by x1.75 - that is 75% extra distance!
Sweet Potato	Crispy Hop	Narrow range: <code>rnd(9, 15)</code> - always between 9 and 15 units
Taco	Shell Spin	Wide range: <code>rnd(2, 26)</code> - could be tiny or huge!
Pizza	Cheese Drag	25% chance to return 0 - zero movement, completely stuck!
Sushi	Rolling Rush	<code>bonus = jumps x 1.6</code> . More jumps = faster! (capped at +13 max)
Donut	Sugar Rush	Check <code>jumps % 3 === 2</code> - every third jump triggers the big one (19-24)!
Corn Dog	Stick Launch	15% chance (<code>Math.random() < 0.15</code>) for a mega jump of 23-30 units
Dumpling	Steam Pop	Return an array [<code>jump1, jump2</code>] - game detects this and fires two jumps!
Ice Cream	Brain Freeze	Set <code>_frozen=true</code> flag - game checks this first and plays freeze animation
Boba Tea	Bubble Pop	Widest range of all: <code>rnd(2, 27)</code> - pure chaos!

Fun fact about Sushi: "Sushi gets faster each jump because we add a bonus each time! The formula is `bonus = jumps x 1.6`, but we cap it at 13 so it does not get TOO crazy. Early in the race Sushi is slow - but near the end, watch out!"

> How to Play Food Bowl Rush!

Everything you need to know in one page!

Food Bowl Rush is super easy to learn. Here are all the controls:

Controls for 2 Players



Player 1 Jump

Team Red



Player 2 Jump

Team Blue



Play Again

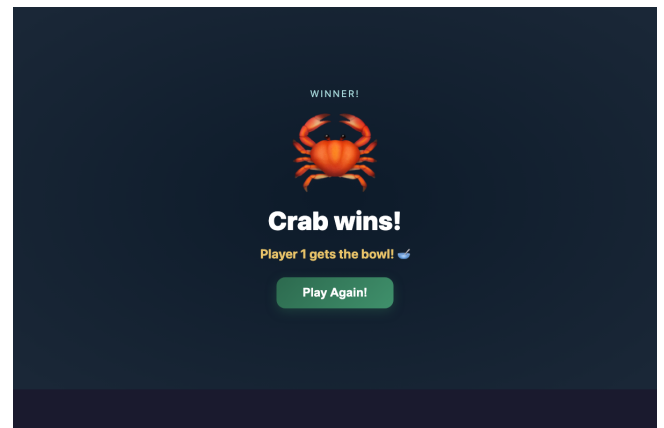
After game

Quick Rules

- Pick your food fighter - each one has a unique jumping style
- Press your key to make your food hop down the track
- Land in the golden bowl zone (between position 92 and 100) to WIN
- Do not overshoot! Going past position 100 means you are eliminated
- There is a cooldown between jumps - no button mashing! (380ms)
- In 4 or 6 player mode, it is team vs team - whole team must be out to lose

The Winner Screen

- The winning food emoji bouncing up and down
- Confetti raining down in all colours
- A fun fanfare sound (ascending musical notes!)
- The food name and which player gets the bowl



Crab wins the bowl!

* What We Learned!

"We built a whole game in one afternoon!"

Building Food Bowl Rush taught us so many things about how computers and games work. Here are the big ideas we picked up:

HTML

HTML is the skeleton of a webpage. We used it to create all the buttons, screens, tracks, and food emojis.

CSS

CSS makes things look beautiful. We used gradients, animations, and transitions to bring the game to life!

JavaScript

JS makes things happen. Key presses, jumps, random numbers, timers - all JavaScript!

Randomness

`Math.random()` gives a number 0 to 1. We use it to make every jump feel different!

Web Audio

We made all sounds using the Web Audio API - no sound files needed! Built boing sounds from scratch!

Game Design

Good games need clear rules, fair chances, and moments of surprise. FBR has all three!

The coolest thing we built: The sound effects are made entirely in code using oscillators - mathematical waves that make different pitches. The "boing" sound starts at 280 Hz and drops to 140 Hz very fast. That falling pitch is what makes it sound bouncy!

A Message for Mom

"Mom, we built this game together as a team! Dad helped with the code and Celine came up with the ideas. Did you know the Crab can walk backwards? That was Celine's idea! We hope you have fun playing Food Bowl Rush. We love you!"

